

Matillion, Made Simple

Turn scattered data into simple, trustworthy dashboards — fast.

What is Matillion?

Think of Matillion as a **bridge between raw data and useful insights**. Businesses generate data everywhere—sales, marketing, websites, apps, finance, and customer service. This data is usually **messy and scattered**, living in different formats and distinct locations like databases, spreadsheets, and external APIs.

Matillion helps **collect, clean, and organize** this data so it can be safely stored in a modern cloud data warehouse (like Snowflake, BigQuery, or Redshift) where it's instantly ready for advanced analysis.

THE EVERYDAY ANALOGY

Without Matillion

Data is like ingredients scattered completely all over the kitchen.

With Matillion

Ingredients are washed, chopped, and neatly placed, completely ready for cooking (analysis).

What Matillion Does (In Human Words)

- **Connects** seamlessly to data sources (Salesforce, Facebook/Google Ads, production databases, raw CSVs, and APIs).
- **Cleans & combines** data using intuitive drag-and-drop "components" without needing heavy, custom engineering code.
- **Schedules** automated data runs (hourly or daily) so target enterprise dashboards remain completely fresh.
- **Orchestrates** end-to-end pipelines including data loading, transformations, strict quality checks, and real-time failure alerts.

ETL vs ELT — What's the Difference?

Matillion's primary architectural advantage is its focus on modern **ELT** over legacy **ETL** frameworks.

Architecture	Where it Cooks	Data Flow Sequence	Best Suited For
ETL Extract, Transform, Load	Outside the data warehouse on a costly, separate processing server.	Pull raw data → reshape outside the ecosystem → push heavy final tables into warehouse.	Smaller data volumes, legacy systems, strict local on-premise rules.
ELT Extract, Load, Transform	Inside the modern cloud warehouse (utilizes its direct horsepower).	Pull data → load completely raw into warehouse → execute all complex transformations directly there.	High-scale big data, cloud environments, rapid agile delivery.

PLAIN ENGLISH ARCHITECTURAL ANALOGY

ETL: Chop veggies in the living room, then carry them heavy to the kitchen to cook.

ELT (Matillion's sweet spot): Take the raw veggies straight to the kitchen first, and do all your prep + cooking directly inside the kitchen.



How Matillion is Different From Other Tools

- **Cloud-Native from the Start:** Built specifically for modern platforms like Snowflake, BigQuery, and Redshift. Legacy tools were adapted from old databases, rendering them far less efficient.
- **ELT Capability:** Leverages the native computing power and elastic scale of the underlying cloud database itself instead of adding intermediate infrastructure bottlenecks.
- **Low-Code / No-Code Interface:** Business analysts can build drag-and-drop pipelines without writing code, while advanced users retain full access to native SQL and Python blocks.
- **Scalability & Speed:** Processes billions of production records within minutes by harnessing cloud horsepower.
- **Cost-Effective Model:** Runs securely inside your existing cloud architecture without needing dedicated secondary physical nodes. You pay strictly for what you use.

Deep Competitor Comparison Matrix

Topic	Matillion	Legacy ETL (Informatica/Talend/ SSIS)	iPaaS (Fivetran/Stitch)
Design Style	Low-code, visual components + native SQL/Python when needed	Heavy, engineering-focused, developer-centric complexity	Mostly prebuilt standard connectors, minimal transformations
Where Work Runs	Inside Snowflake / BigQuery / Redshift (True ELT)	Outside on dedicated legacy middle-tier ETL infrastructure servers	Proprietary vendor platform; highly limited push-down queries
Scale & Speed	Leverages elastically scaling warehouse power (billions of rows)	Frequently runs into processing bottlenecks on physical ETL servers	Great for initial basic ingestion; struggles with heavy logic modeling
Flexibility	Strong data transformations, strict orchestration, and high quality checks	Extremely powerful system architecture but highly complex & pricey	Very easy to start, but limited for complex data manipulation logic
Cost Model	Cloud-friendly utility pricing: pay for exactly what you use	Traditional heavy licensing commitments + local server infrastructure costs	Subscription model priced per active connector or absolute row counts

Architectural Summary (TL;DR):

- Choose **Matillion** for modern analytics on Snowflake/BigQuery/Redshift with low-code builds and serious transformation requirements.
- Choose **iPaaS** if you only require raw data ingestion with minimal business logic modeling.
- Choose **Traditional ETL** if your stack is permanently locked into on-premise legacy infrastructures.



Common Use Cases (Non-Technical Friendly)

Marketing Analytics ROI

Pulls data across Facebook Ads, Google Analytics, and LinkedIn Ads into one clean dataset to pinpoint exact campaign ROI, CAC, and ROAS.

Unified Sales Reporting

Merges CRM (Salesforce) data, billing systems, and emails into centralized dashboards displaying revenue trends and forecast accuracy.

Finance & Compliance

Standardizes transactional records across disparate ERP systems and international banking endpoints for automated audits and budgeting packs.

Customer 360 View

Stitches product usage, historical customer support tickets, and website interactions into a singular unified master user profile.

Operational Supply Chain

Unifies real-time warehouse inventories and retail store supply metrics to automatically alert managers on low stock and reorder schedules.

Executive Dashboards

Consolidates metrics like MRR, Corporate NPS, and Customer Lifetime Value (LTV) refreshed cleanly on a nightly schedule.



Technical Decision & Implementation Guide

When to Formally Choose Matillion

- ✓ Your central production data lives (or will soon live) directly within Snowflake, BigQuery, or Redshift.
- ✓ You need rapid pipeline delivery via visual drag-and-drop configurations but require custom developer code extensions.
- ✓ You expect massive data volume growth and require zero-overhead horizontal scaling without managing physical physical nodes.
- ✓ You require governed, repeatable production pipelines complete with built-in monitoring and active alerts.

Mini Storyboard Pipeline (1-Minute Pitch)

1

Collect raw records from active production tools.

2

Load raw records directly into Snowflake as-is.

3

Clean, transform, and join tables inside Snowflake.

4

Power BI / Tableau updates dynamically every morning.



Executive Speaking Notes & Verification Checklist

"Think of Matillion as our data chef. It works entirely inside our kitchen (Snowflake/BigQuery) so our business-critical meals (dashboards) are prepared fast and remain perfectly consistent. ELT is modern because we leverage our warehouse's massive computing horsepower rather than buying expensive separate servers. This slashes cost, speeds up project delivery, and scales smoothly alongside our company's growth."

Quick Fit Evaluation

- ✓ Are you utilizing Snowflake, BigQuery, or Redshift today or in the near future? → **Yes** → **Matillion Fits**
- ✓ Do you require complex row joins, calculations, and custom data logic beyond simple copying? → **Yes** → **Matillion Fits**
- ✓ Do you want analytics teams to build data pipelines autonomously without deep software programming? → **Yes** → **Matillion Fits**